Pakistan dairy and meat sectors

Ten fiscal years: FY2016-17 to FY2025-26. Prepared 25 October 2026. A classroom comparison of production trends and practical improvement opportunities.

Measure	Dairy proxy	Meat proxy
Series	Milk available for human consumption	Total meat, including poultry
Start: 2016-17	45.227 million tonnes	4.061 million tonnes
End: 2025-26	60.185 million tonnes	6.314 million tonnes
Total change	33.1%	55.5%
Annual compound growth	3.23%	5.03%
Interpretation	Volume increased; profitability is not measured.	Volume increased faster; productivity is not measured.

Source: Pakistan Economic Survey 2025-26, Agriculture, Statistical Appendix Table 2.1 B (continued) and Tables 2.14-2.15. Calculations by the author. Ten observations contain nine annual growth intervals. FY2025-26 is provisional.

Annual production comparison

Units: thousand tonnes. Milk is the human-consumption series, not gross milk production. Growth is calculated from the preceding row; the first year is the baseline.

Fiscal year	Milk	Meat	Milk YoY	Meat YoY
2016-17	45,227	4,061	Baseline	Baseline
2017-18	46,682	4,262	3.22%	4.95%
2018-19	48,185	4,478	3.22%	5.07%
2019-20	49,737	4,708	3.22%	5.14%
2020-21	51,340	4,954	3.22%	5.23%
2021-22	52,996	5,220	3.23%	5.37%
2022-23	54,707	5,503	3.23%	5.42%
2023-24	56,474	5,809	3.23%	5.56%
2024-25	58,300	5,967	3.23%	2.72%
2025-26	60,185	6,314	3.23%	5.82%

Source: Economic Survey 2025-26, Appendix Table 2.1 B (continued). FY2025-26 provisional. Output estimates rely on livestock population assumptions; smooth growth should not be read as direct annual measurement of farm performance.

Comparing improvement priorities

The following is an author-prepared teaching framework, not a measured record of adoption. National output growth alone cannot establish which farm practices caused it.

Area	Dairy improvement opportunity	Meat improvement opportunity
Feeding	Plan seasonal fodder and reduce feed waste.	Match feeding to growth stage and track feed cost.
Animal records	Track milk per animal and reproductive events.	Track weights, mortality and sale outcomes.
Health	Use local veterinary preventive care.	Use biosecurity and preventive veterinary care.
Product handling	Improve clean collection and prompt cooling.	Improve hygienic handling and temperature control.
Market access	Compare reliable buyers and quality terms.	Compare buyers, grading and market requirements.
Business review	Measure cost per unit of milk sold.	Measure cost per unit of liveweight or meat sold.

How students should interpret the data

Separate observed changes in the selected series from claims requiring additional evidence. These distinctions apply throughout the ten-year comparison.

Question	What this report supports	What else is needed
Did output expand?	Both selected volume series increased.	No extra series for this narrow comparison.
Which grew faster?	Total meat grew faster in percentage terms.	Consistent definitions when adding other sources.
Did animal productivity improve?	Not established by total production.	Milk yield and weight gain per animal.
Did profits improve?	Not established by volume growth.	Farm revenues, feed costs and other expenses.
Did quality improve?	Not measured in these tables.	Quality testing and handling indicators.
Was growth caused by technology?	No causal conclusion is made.	Adoption data and a suitable evaluation design.

Sources, definitions and limitations

Keep these notes with the tables when teaching or quoting the report. The report compares output; improvement opportunities are suggestions, not verified historical achievements.

Item	Explanation
Primary source	Ministry of Finance, Pakistan Economic Survey 2025-26, Agriculture chapter. Appendix Table 2.1 B (continued) provides the annual series; Tables 2.14-2.15 provides definitions and estimation notes.
Milk definition	Milk available for human consumption is used consistently across the ten years. It differs from gross milk production.
Meat definition	Total meat includes beef, mutton and poultry. It is not a red-meat-only series.
Estimation limits	Survey livestock estimates use inter-census growth assumptions from the 1996 and 2006 livestock censuses. Survey notes anticipate revisions after complete newer census production results.
Formulae	Total change = (end/start - 1) x 100. CAGR = ((end/start)^(1/9) - 1) x 100. YoY = (current/previous - 1) x 100.
Scope	Ten fiscal-year observations, nine growth intervals. Latest year provisional. No claim is made about inflation-adjusted income, animal yield, or causal impacts.

Official source: Pakistan Economic Survey 2025-26 - Agriculture

https://www.finance.gov.pk/survey/chapter_26/2_Agriculture.pdf